

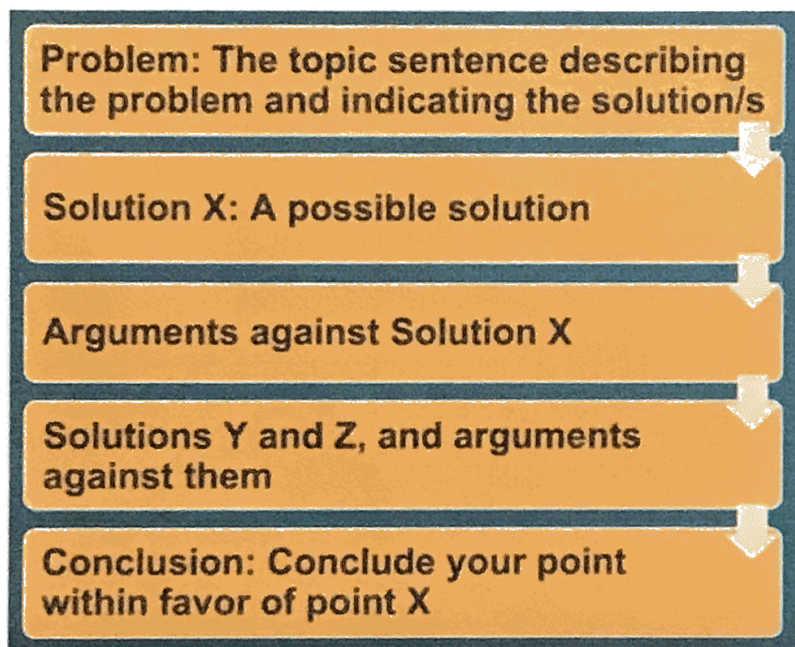
Structuring and Composing Problem-Solution Paragraphs

Video 1: Structure of Problem-Solution Paragraphs

What Are Problem-Solution Paragraphs?

- Explaining a problem and proposing one or multiple solutions to that problem
- Minimum importance given to the problem, more to the solution
- Explanation of the problem - a set of solutions

Structure of a Problem-Solution Paragraph



Example

Example

Topic sentence

Academic writing can be improved by adopting a few strategies over a period of time, as there is no single strategy to improve it. It is difficult to master academic writing as it is different from general writing.

Argument against the solution: One of the most popular strategies is to utilize academic writing workbooks. However, without receiving feedback on the writing, it may be difficult to make much progress only through writing. Another strategy could be writing with the help of software like Grammarly. Though Grammarly may help identify grammatical errors, research indicates that it may not be helpful when you lack a sense of accuracy.

Argument against the solution: People also take the help of online writing courses to improve their writing. If these courses are not monitored by an expert and regular feedback is not provided, they cannot improve writing. Overall, instead of depending on one strategy, the use of multiple strategies will surely help improve academic writing.

First solution

Second solution

Third solution

Concluding sentence

Video 2: Introductory and Concluding Sentences in Problem - Solution Paragraphs

Topic Sentence

- Introduction of the problem and the solution ideas:

The expansion of the university campus is hindered by a number of factors that need to be addressed immediately.

- Topic + Problem:

Undernourishment is an alarming issue that gets inadequate attention across all developing and underdeveloped countries.

- Components of the topic sentence: topic (problem) + controlling idea (solution)

Climate change has significant impact on human lives across the world and, therefore, efforts should be made globally to address the crisis.

Concluding Sentence

- Exploring all the solutions to the problem and concluding with the solution/s that is/ are better than the rest.

Apart from country-level efforts, more global gatherings such as the 2021 United Nations Climate Change Conference in which climate change issues are openly discussed and concrete plans to address the issue are made are necessary.

- Highlighting only the best solution

If each country makes efforts to meet a yearly carbon emission reduction target, the problem of climate change can be addressed.

- Emphasizing the value of all solutions

Reducing carbon emissions, controlling population growth, making public transport more efficient, and conducting plantation drives can save the planet from the menace of climate change.

Video 3: Description of the Problem

Description of the Problem

- Beginning with a brief description of the problem
- Reasons behind the problem
- At times, evidence to provide more clarity about the problem

Example of Description of a Problem

The Problem: Mastering academic writing

Description of a Problem + Reasons

It is difficult to master academic writing as it is different from general writing and involves complex norms.

Nature of the Problem and its Impact

The challenges of academic writing can arise from the use of discipline-specific register, discourse features, citation and referencing conventions, etc.

Using problem + solution 1 + critique 1 + solution 2 + critique 2 ... structure

Example

Academic writing can be improved by adopting a few strategies over a period of time, as there is no single strategy to improve it. It is difficult to master academic writing as it is different from general writing. One of the most popular strategies is to utilise academic writing workbooks. However, without receiving feedback on the writing, it may be difficult to make much progress only through writing. Another strategy could be writing with the help of software like Grammarly. Though Grammarly may help identify grammatical errors, research indicates that it may not be helpful when you lack a sense of accuracy. People also take the help of online writing courses to improve their writing. If these courses are not monitored by an expert and regular feedback is not provided, they cannot improve writing. Overall, instead of depending on one strategy, the use of multiple strategies will surely help improve academic writing.

Video 4: Description of the Solution

Description of the Solution

- Block vs. point-to-point structure

Description of a problem first

Description of a solution

- One ideal solution or multiple solutions to a problem

The effectiveness of each solution explained with possible counter-arguments

Point-to-Point Solution

Academic writing can be improved by adopting a few strategies over a period of time, as there is no single strategy to improve it. It is difficult to master academic writing as it is different from general writing. A major challenge is to learn to use the discipline-specific vocabulary. One can learn that by reading articles and using workbooks. However, without receiving feedback on the vocabulary use, it may be difficult to make much progress only through writing. The next challenge could be using discourse features correctly. With proper guidance from a tutor, one can learn to use academic discourse features in writing. Though many people claim expertise on academic writing, finding efficient tutors and being able to afford them are arduous tasks.

Block Solution

- Sometimes problems and solutions are in two separate paragraphs

There are several strategies using which a student can improve their academic writing. First, one can utilize academic writing workbooks. However, without receiving feedback on the writing, it may be difficult to make much progress only through writing. Another strategy could be writing with the help of software like Grammarly. Though Grammarly may help identify grammatical errors, research indicates that it may not be helpful when you lack a sense of accuracy. People also take the help of online writing courses to improve their writing. If these courses are not monitored by an expert and regular feedback is not provided, they cannot improve writing.

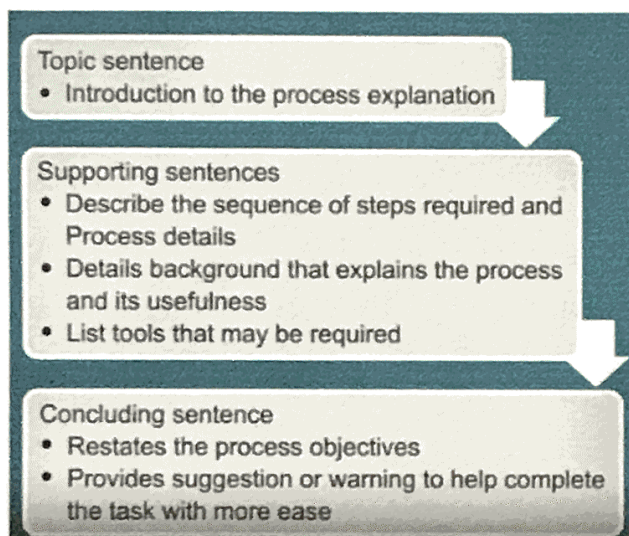
Structuring and Composing Process Paragraphs

Video 1: Structure of Process Paragraphs

What Is a Process Paragraph?

- Describes the process of doing something
- Explains various steps required to achieve desired results
- Follows a logical order
- Connects the series of steps

Structure of a Process Paragraph

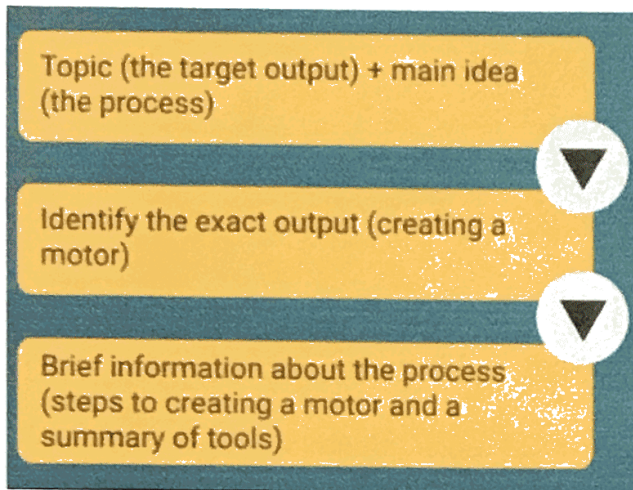


Process Paragraph Example

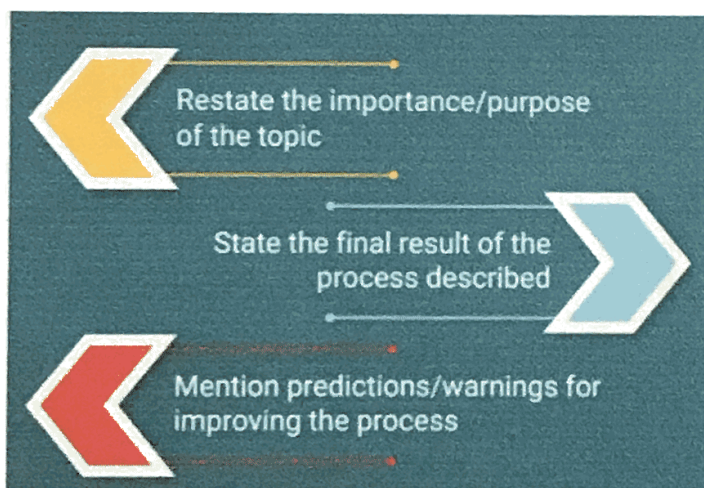
A good PowerPoint presentation for academic purposes can be prepared if a series of steps are followed. First, a Microsoft PowerPoint file is opened and given a name. Then, a proper design and background and font colours and sizes are chosen for titles and texts. After entering all the texts in bullet point form, appropriate illustrations are entered. Lastly, all the points and illustrations are animated. Apart from following the aforementioned steps, thorough proofreading and editing are necessary to make PowerPoint presentations effective.

Video 2: Introductory and Concluding Sentences in Process Paragraphs

Topic Sentence



Concluding Sentence

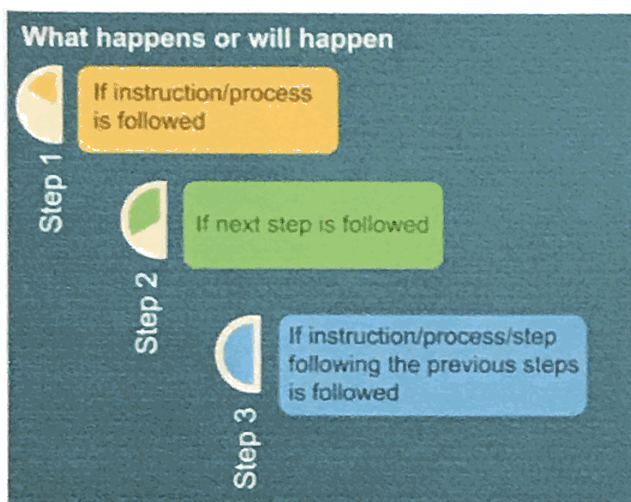


Video 3: Following a Chronological Order in Process Paragraphs

Why Chronological Order?

- Step-by-step process
- One step followed by another
- Target output dependent on the right order

Chronological Order



Example

How is a car cleaned?

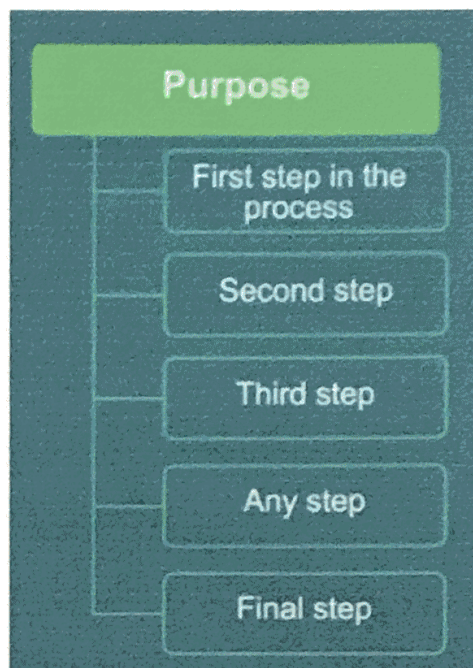
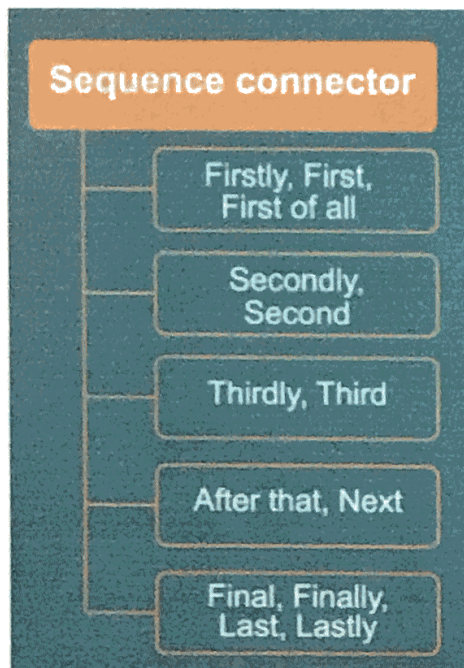
Step 1: First, the car is cleaned with a duster to remove dust and other such particles.

Step 2: Then, 25 ml. of car shampoo is added to 15 liters of water in a bucket.

Step 3: After that, the shampoo water is used to clean the body of the car with a piece of cleaning sponge.

Step 4: Finally, the car's body is washed with clean water, and the car is wiped with a piece of microfiber cloth.

Language Indicating Order



Video 4: Using Passive Structures Process Paragraphs

Use of Passive Structures

- Usual in scientific writing, especially process writing
- Popular in research writing
- Not mandatory, depends on instructions

Examples

Describe the process in the methods section	
Active	Passive
• We collected data • I interviewed 20 people for the study • We used a new processor in the PC	• Data were collected • Twenty people were interviewed for the study • A new processor was used in the PC

Passive Form in Process Paragraphs

- Focus on the process, not on the agent:
Example: The font size and color are decided.
- Preparing filter coffee
 - Passive: The water is brought to boil
 - Active: You bring the water to boil
 - Subject is omitted and action is emphasized

Passive structures:

- is/am/are/was/were + past participle
- has/have/had been + past participle
- can/could/will/would/may/might/shall/should + be + past participle

Structuring and Composing Paragraphs Describing Visual Information

Video 1: Structure of Paragraphs Describing Visual Information

Composing a Paragraph Describing Visual Information

- Academic writing in science: visual representation to present statistical data
- A large quantity of information through graphs and tables
- Visual information usually conveys the whole data
- Writing about visual data: interpretation, identification of patterns
- Tables and figures (graphs, charts, etc.)
- Numbering tables and figures and reference in the text

Example

Table 1: The percentage of car types produced in the years 2018 and 2019

Car Type	Sedan	SUV	MUVs	Convertibles	Hatchback
2018	20	30	15	10	25
2019	25	40	5	5	25

The table displays the production percentage of various types of cars during the years 2018 and 2019. [While the production of SUVs and sedans increased during the two years, the production percentage MUVs and convertibles decreased significantly and hatchbacks remained steady during the period.] ... Overall, the demand for large cars shot up during the two-year period.

Types of visual

Key verb indicating the function

Description point

The table displays the production percentage of various types of cars during the years 2018 and 2019. [While the production of SUVs and sedans increased during the two years, the production percentage MUVs and convertibles decreased significantly and hatchbacks remained steady during the period.] ... Overall, the demand for large cars shot up during the two-year period.

Verb indicating pattern

The most important pattern

Conclusion

Video 2: Writing Introductory and Concluding Sentences

Writing Topic Sentences

The table illustrates the difference in wheat production across various European countries during 2012 to 2022.

Kind of visual (table or figure?)	What the table/figure intends to do	Specifying the scope
The table	illustrates the difference in the wheat production	across various European countries during 2012 to 2022.

So when we talk about writing the topic sentence in visual information based paragraphs we are thinking about how we can follow the same kind of topic sentence structure that we learned earlier. We learned that a topic sentence has two parts a topic and main idea or a controlling idea. Now in this case, when we are talking about describing visual information, in such paragraphs we are thinking about the first part, the topic is to think about what is topic and what is it that we need to describe here? So in this case it may not be you know exactly in a rigid manner. You may not be able to follow the same pattern that you follow for a general academic paragraph, like a topic or a main idea or a topic or a controlling idea. So here, when we talk about a sentence like the table illustrates the difference in the wheat production across various European countries during 2012 to 2022. So in a case like this, you start with the table is something the kind of visual,. This is something that you keep in mind that the table, the visual. So you make it clear whether it's a table or a figure. You have two choices. You have either you have to choose a table or you talk about the figure. Then you think about what is it that it intends to do? It illustrates the differences in the wheat production. So this is more or less our main idea or our controlling idea because this is what we'll be talking about in the paragraph. And then specifying the scope further adding to the scope of the paragraph, we talk about across various European countries, we are limiting the scope to only European countries and again limiting the time period to 2012 to 2022. So this is something that you keep in mind. So first part is the kind of visual, second part what the table or figure intends to do. Third part, specifying the scope, okay? Now let's think about how we can do this when we have a figure and how we write it.

Writing Concluding Sentences

- Regular approach: describing opinion/prediction/warning, highlighting the most important pattern
- Transitional sentence: leading to the next paragraph, connecting with the most important pattern

Clearly, the emphasis in the IELTS examination is on writing, with essay writing being the most important component.

In the subsequent section, the reasons behind the emphasis on writing performance in the IELTS examination will be analyzed.

Video 3: Use of Different Types of Visuals in Academic Texts

Type of Visual

Table	Figure
Table	Diagram Map Pie Chart Bar Chart Line Graph

Now, when we think about these, we saw one table and we saw different types of figures. Under table, we have just the table under that category. Under figure, we have a diagram, we have a map, we have a pie chart, we have a bar chart, we have a line graph. Whenever you are using a diagram or a map pie chart, or a bar chart, or a line graph, you need to refer to those as figures. Instead of calling it a diagram in the beginning, you can start the sentence by calling them a figure, Figure 1, Figure 2, Figure 3, rather than writing Diagram 1, Bar chart 1 or Pie chart 1. We don't do that in academic texts generally. We refer to all these things as figures. Something that you need to remember and start using if you have not done so in your academic writing, start doing that

Usage of Visual Information in Paragraphs

Diagram: systematic drawing to explain information

Table: statistical information

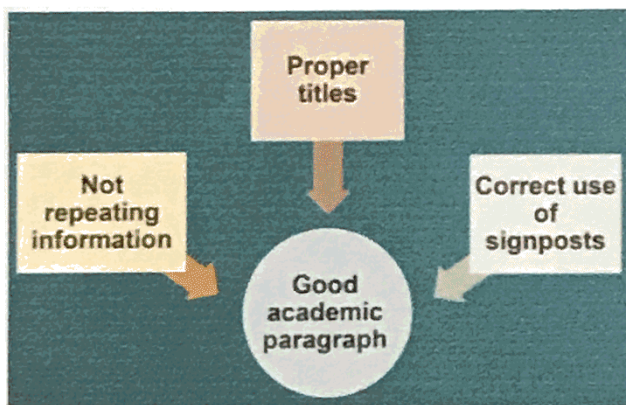
Map: location

Pie chart: numerical proportion

Bar chart: plotting numeric values for various categories

Line graph: information that changes over time

Description of Visual Information in Paragraphs



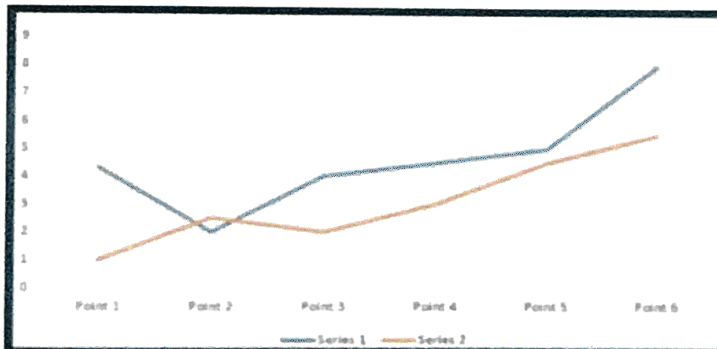
First thing, generally in a good academic paragraph, we need to have a proper title. The first and most important thing is to use a proper title for your visual. Then use appropriate signposts to talk about the visuals. The most important patterns, or the next important patterns, the explanations, all those things, you should use appropriate signposts so that the presentation is effective. Another important thing is not to repeat information that is presented in the paragraph.

Video 4: Language and Planning for Describing Visual Information

Language Use

- The table/figure
Shows, illustrates, displays, presents
- Verbs
Rise, increase, grow, climb, fall, decline, decrease, drop, dip, decrease, remain stable, not change, remain steady, stay constant, crash, collapse, plunge, plummet
- Adverbs
Significantly, substantially, rapidly, sharply, steeply, considerably, steadily, continuously, constantly, slightly, minimally, markedly
- Adjectives
Significant, substantial, rapidly, sharp, steep, considerable, slight, minimal, little

Example



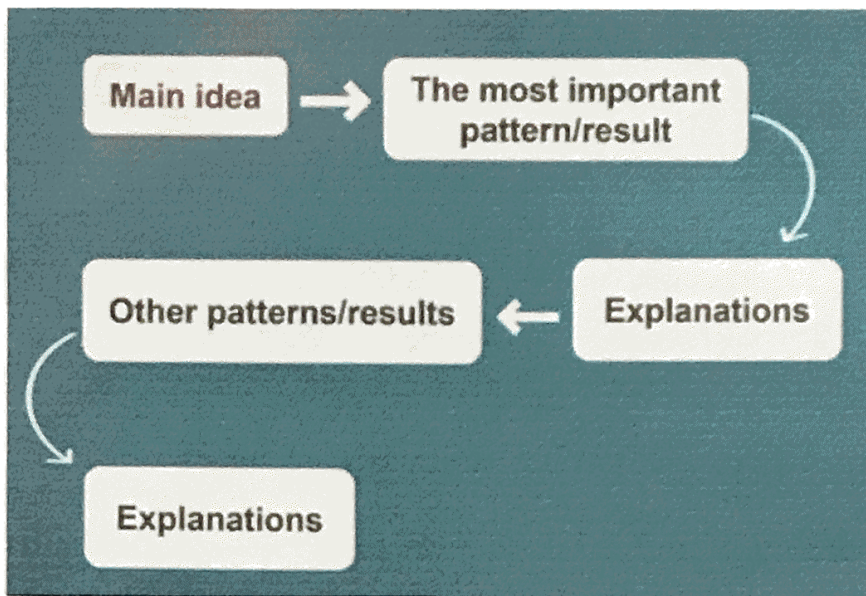
Series 1:

1-2 sharp fall/fell sharply
2-5 rose steadily
3-4 grew slightly

Series 2:

1-2 increased significantly
2-3 showed minimal decline
3-6 grew constantly

Planning for Describing Visual Information



When you are writing an academic paragraph describing visual information, think about the main idea, what to write, and make sure that the pattern is what you are going to highlight, the controlling idea is highlighted. Then think about the most important pattern or the most important result. Such kind of writing is generally you find in the results section, so most important result or pattern. Then think about kind of explanation why this is happening generally and results sections you write why this is happening. I write an explanation if you are writing the results section, or then you move to other patterns which are next important pattern, the most important one, next most important one, pattern like that you go on. Then you conclude, again, you will add an explanation, and then you finally conclude it with re-emphasizing what you are doing in the paragraph when what you have highlighted in the topic sentence through the main idea.